We won on the Constitutional amendment to balance the budget, 69 to 31. Russell Long gave us the deciding vote. Met with Jack Kemp (alone) and then in leadership meeting. He is adamant that we are wrong on the tax increase. [I had finally approved an increase of $98.3 billion in business and excise taxes over three years in return for a Democratic promise of $280 billion in budget cuts over three years.] He is in fact unreasonable. The tax increase is the price we have to pay to get the budget cuts.

Aug. 6

Well, we won't go to the ranch next Wednesday—the Congress will still be here and probably voting on the tax bill. But the good news is we'll be going a week from Wed. and get an extra week added on until after Labor Day.

Aug. 7

At the W.H. No Camp David. Spent most of day working on a tentative speech re the economy and explaining my support of the tax increase bill. It's a price we have to pay to get more budget cuts.

Aug. 8

Again at W.H. More of Saturday's work plus a long letter I feel I have to write to Loyal. I'm afraid for him. His health is failing badly. [As a young man, Nancy's father had an experience that had made him question his faith in God; I believed strongly in a supreme being and wanted to convince him he was wrong and should see a minister before he died and acknowledge a belief and faith in God, so I could not resist writing and urging him to do so.]

Aug. 9